First News

1 April 2026 Wednesday

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control.

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Global, Regional Markets

Stock traders sparked a euphoric rally, piling into US equities after reports that Masoud Pezeshkian signaled willingness to end the war, raising hopes of de-escalation and easing geopolitical risk.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian issued a statement on Tuesday that immediately sent shockwaves through global financial markets. "Iran does not seek war and is ready to end it—but only in exchange for formal security guarantees protecting the country from further attacks."

Wall Street staged a sharp relief rally led by tech on short covering and bargain hunting

- Fear Index -9% but remains at extreme levels, signaling fear is easing but not gone

Safe-Haven Gold stays firm

Oil prices remain elevated Risk-on bounce, but underlying stress persists.

Warren Buffett cautioned that he’s seeing signs of fragility emerging in the banking system as it has become more connected to non-bank players.

US March Consumer Confidence Rises to 91.8; Est. 87.9

Previous news:

- President Trump has informed aides of his willingness to end the U.S. military campaign against Iran even if the Strait of Hormuz remains closed, marking a strategic pivot away from a forced reopening.
- While pursuing this drawdown, President Trump is simultaneously threatening to destroy Iranian energy infrastructure if a deal is not reached by early April.

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Asia-Pacific

	3/31/2026	4/1/2026	%Chg
Dow Jones	45,216	46,341	2.49%
S&P 500	6,344	6,528	2.90%
NASDAQ	30,795	21,590	-29.89%
PCOMP	5,869	5,869	0.00%
NKY	51,885	51,063	-1.58%
SHCOMP	3923	3891	-0.82%
HSI	24,750	24,788	0.15%
KOSPI	5277	5052	-4.26%
SENSEX	71,947	71,947	0.00%
TWSE	32,518	31,722	-2.45%
ASX200	8460	8617	1.86%
BURSAKLCI	1687	1690	0.18%
JCI	7091	7048	-0.61%
STI	4897	4885	-0.25%
SET	967	969	0.21%
VNINDEX	1662	1674	0.72%

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Commodities - Metals & Agriculture

	3/31/2026	4/1/2026	%Chg
WTI Crude	106.11	101.77	-4.09%
Brent Crude	109.29	103.97	-4.87%
Gold (Comex)	4546	4704	3.48%
Silver (Comex)	70.01	75.44	7.76%
Platinum Spot	1874	1959	4.54%
Copper (Comex)	547	564	3.11%
Nickel	7.7201	7.6475	-0.94%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.8%	78	79	1.28%
Nickel Ore Phl 1.5%	93	93.5	0.54%
Coal	144.25	142.45	-1.25%
Corn	456	457.75	0.38%
Wheat	611.5	616.25	0.78%
Cocoa	3155	3300	4.60%
Sugar	15.55	15.52	-0.19%

Strategy

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Philippines

Philippines to Sell TBills On April 6
P9 Billion 364-Day
P9 Billion 182-Day
P9 Billion 91-Day
* No rates yet

BSP now expects a wider balance of payments deficit of $7.8b for this year compared with an earlier estimate of $5.9b, citing global risks including the Middle East conflict.

- 2026 current account deficit will likely widen to $20.3b this year from a $15.3b gap projected in 4Q,

3/31/26 Tuesday Global Funds Net Buyers AEV ACEN AT CEB ICT LTG MEG MREIT MAC PCOR PX ROCK SHLPH SGP SM SMPH

3/31/26 Tuesday Global Funds Net Sellers ALI AC APX BDO BPI CNVRG GLO JGS PGOLD MWC MBT MYNLD PLUS RLC RCR SCC TEL WEB

The Philippines will suspend work in government offices from 12 noon on Wednesday 4/1/26

Philippines consumer inflation seen at 3.1%–3.9% this month — BSP

USD/PHP

- The Philippine peso strengthened after weakening the previous day. The Philippines' 10-year bond yield fell 4.03 basis points to 6.98% on Monday.
- Global investors sold a net $25.5 million of Philippine stocks on Monday. The current benchmark rate is 4.25%.

DA MARKET SECURITIES

Philippines

Employing Intelligent investing, a disciplined, long-term approach to wealth creation based on fundamental analysis, risk management, and emotional control,

5948 79.45pts., +1.35%

Range 5,828.67-5,948.94

Breadth 125 (+) 79 (-) 62 (unch)

Block Php1.05bn **Volume** 1.03bn **Value** Php9.82bn

Share buyback ICT SM SMPH OPM AGI MEG FRUIT

52wk H: axlm rrhi
52wk L: ali allhc atn bdo bhi bpi ceb eei medic mm zhi

Overbought – rrhi axlm
Oversold – lbc ali dmw tech atn shlph

Active	Value
ICT	1920
BDO	1210
ALI	785
MBT	500
BPI	484
SM	354
SMPH	345
PLUS	290
AC	193

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Foreign Trade

NFB(S)	$11.725mn
Total Month FB/(FS)	-$34.885mn
YTD NFB	$145.541mn
FB	5,630,289,194.81
FS	6,342,623,397.00
NFB(S)	-712,334,202.19
TOTAL	11,972,912,591.81

Foreign Funds Bought
aub cbc pnb secb dhi acen ap fgen mer pcor sgp shlph monde aev cosco gtcap ltg sm smc areit egrn meg mrc mreit rock smph dito tel ceb ict mac sti bloom plus mrsgi at px

Foreign Funds Sold
bdo bpi mbt pse crec fph mwc mynld scc spc spnec cnpf dnl gsmi jfc keepr rfm urc imi ac agi jgs ali allhc creit fli rcr rlc glo cnvrg web pgold rrhi sevn wlcon apx nikl ogp

Share Buy-Back Transactions
OPM SM SMPH MEG

Smart Watch 3/25/26
Investors are actively squaring off long & short bets to reduce risk exposure before the holiday break. MER GLO PGOLD SGP RRHI DHI

10yr Bond	3/31/...	4/1/...	%Chg
PHL	6.929	6.96	0.45%
US	4.356	4.311	-1.03%

Currency Pair	3/31...	4/1/...	%Chg
USD-JPY	159.59	158.66	0.64%
USD-PHP	60.73	60.744	0.06%
USD-CNY	6.9107	6.8945	0.24%
EUR-USD	1.1493	1.1563	-0.35%

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

ALI

- **Worst single-session drop since the pandemic. Dual headwind: rates + construction cost inflation**
- Ayala Land says its executive committee approved a buyback program worth up to 10b pesos. The program will start April 1, it says in bourse filing

OGP 31.95

- **Didipio mine life extended to 2037 at a $2,200/oz reserve price vs. actual $4,546. Massive NPV understatement.**

SCC

- **Coal block auction deadline April 28. Energy emergency = SCC's best operating environment in years.**

WEB

- **PAGCOR accreditation secured before the April 1 deadline. -7% decline is the entry, not the exit**

DMC

- **DMCI Holdings is lifting its capital expenditure budget to P24.6 billion in 2026, up 11% from P22.2 billion in 2025. The bulk — P15.5 billion or 65% — goes to property arm DMCI Homes, while DMCI Power gets P3.3 billion for 44 MW of new capacity in Palawan, Occidental Mindoro, and Calapan.**
- Full-year 2025 net income fell 20% to P15.1 billion, with Semirara's contribution down sharply on softer energy prices, while the cement unit Concreat posted a P1.9 billion net loss.
- Analysis: The capex ramp signals management's confidence in residential demand recovery and off-grid power expansion. However, the earnings backdrop remains soft — Semirara pressure and Concreat's ongoing losses are headwinds that won't clear quickly. The P15.5B for DMCI Homes is actually lower than the P17.9B allocated in 2025, suggesting a more disciplined, pace-and-price approach rather than outright expansion. Shares fell 1.94% to P9.61 on Tuesday.
- Stance: MONITOR. No clear near-term catalyst. Earnings recovery contingent on coal/power price normalization and cement turnaround. Watch for Q1 2026 guidance.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

SGP

- **NGCP — Proposes P23.9B Batangas-Mindoro Subsea Cable**
- The National Grid Corp. of the Philippines is proposing a 500-kV submarine cable crossing the Verde Island Passage from Lobo, Batangas to Calapan City, Oriental Mindoro — a 28.5-kilometer link targeting completion by January 2028.
- The subsea cable forms Stage 1 of the broader P90.6-billion Batangas-Mindoro Interconnection and Backbone Project (BMIBP), which the Department of Energy has certified as a project of national significance.
- SGP is the listed vehicle holding a 40.20% effective ownership interest in the National Grid Corporation of the Philippines (NGCP), the sole private operator of the country's power transmission grid.
- Maharlika Investment Corp. (MIC) recently acquired a 20% stake in SGP, increasing government influence over grid operations at a moment when transmission capacity and reliability are national security priorities. SGP closed at ₱21.45 on 3/27 (+2.39%), with foreign funds buying on 3/30.
- Analysis: SGP is the only way to get listed exposure to NGCP, which sits at the intersection of every major energy theme in the current crisis: renewable energy integration (MTerra, EPI, CREIT), transmission reliability amid fuel supply disruptions, and the government's push for energy independence. Grid bottlenecks are the binding constraint on how fast MTerra, CREIT, ACEN, and EPI can actually deliver clean power to end-users — NGCP's capex and transmission expansion are therefore directly correlated to the RE sector's growth ceiling.
- Stance: ACCUMULATE SGP. The only listed proxy for NGCP, the backbone of every energy transaction in the Philippines. MIC's 20% stake signals government commitment to grid investment. RE expansion cannot happen without transmission capacity. Foreign buying on 3/30 confirms institutional recognition of the thesis.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

GTCAP 520.00

- **GTCAP (GT Capital Holdings) — Acquires 20% Stake in Federal Land NRE Global (FNG) for ₱9.16B; Riverpark Coordination Rationale**
- GT Capital acquired 91.61 million shares — a 20% direct stake in FNG — from its wholly owned subsidiary Federal Land, Inc. for ₱9.16 billion (₱100/share). The deal, completed March 30, is effectively an internal restructuring within the Ty group's property interests, giving GT Capital a direct seat at FNG's table alongside Nomura Real Estate Development Co., Japan. FNG develops properties in Cavite, Pasay, Mandaluyong, and Cebu; its flagship is the 600-hectare Riverpark township in General Trias, Cavite, where the first tranche of commercial lots sold out in 2025 and UNIQLO's largest Southeast Asian warehouse is set to open in H1 2026.
- **Analysis:** The transaction consolidates GT Capital's oversight of Riverpark — arguably the Ty group's most strategically significant land development — directly at the holding company level rather than through Federal Land. No new capital leaves the group; this is governance rationalization, not expansion. The value unlock comes from better alignment of land bank strategy with GT Capital's ₱33.68 billion FY2025 earnings base. FNG's Riverpark pipeline (commercial lots, industrial, mixed-use) benefits from direct holding company-level prioritization and capital access. GTCAP at ₱519.50 remains below its intrinsic value at P/E 7-8x given the group's earnings quality.
- S**tance: ACCUMULATE GTCAP. Internal restructuring that improves strategic alignment without cash outflow from the group. Riverpark remains the long-term land monetization thesis. GTCAP's FY2025 earnings of ₱33.68B (+17%) with Metrobank, Toyota, and MPIC all at record levels provides a strong fundamental floor.**

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

CREC 4.59, CREIT 3.40

- **CREC / CREIT (Citicore Renewable Energy Corp.) — Energizes 69MW Solar Project in Negros Occidental; First of Six Planned for 2026**
- Citicore Renewable Energy Corp. energized a 69MW solar project in Silay City, Negros Occidental — the first of six solar plants it targets to energize in 2026 with a combined capacity of 484MW. The project spans 69 hectares with expansion potential to 100MW, and incorporates the company's AgroSolar Initiative, which integrates crop production beneath solar panels. FY2025 net income rose 14% to ₱1.15 billion; consolidated revenues grew 3% to ₱5.32 billion.
- Analysis: Adding 69MW during a declared national energy emergency is as timely as it gets. Visayas grid stability has been strained by the same fuel supply disruptions affecting Luzon, making indigenous renewable capacity additions immediately valuable. The 484MW target across six plants in 2026 — against a prior operating base of approximately 293MW at end-2025 — represents a roughly 65% capacity expansion in a single year. If executed, CREIT's contracted revenue base grows substantially, supporting a higher dividend distribution to unitholders. The AgroSolar framing also strengthens ESG positioning for institutional fund inclusion.
- Stance: ACCUMULATE CREIT. 69MW Negros online is the first of six 2026 milestones. 65% capacity expansion target in one year at the peak of the energy emergency = maximum strategic and commercial impact. FY2025 fundamentals (+14% NI, -19% finance costs) confirm the underlying quality.

PCOR 2.91, SMC 71.80

- **PCOR / SMC (Petron Corp. / San Miguel Corp.) — Petron Stake Sale to Government "Modestly Credit Positive" — CreditSights; SMC Can Sell Up to 35.6% Without "Change of Control"**
- Financial research firm CreditSights described a potential government acquisition of a stake in Petron as "modestly credit positive in the longer-term," citing improved financial support, better access to bank financing at lower cost, and the government's higher credit rating providing additional credit support. CreditSights maintained its "Outperform" recommendation on Petron's $475 million perpetual bond. It noted that SMC could sell up to a 35.6% stake to the government without triggering a "change of control" provision. BusinessWorld Online
- **Analysis:** CreditSights' endorsement of the deal's credit quality cuts both ways: it validates the strategic logic of the government taking a minority stake, while also making clear this is not a full nationalization scenario. The 35.6% maximum tranche that avoids a change of control is the structural sweet spot — the government gets energy security upside (strategic national asset, fuel supply oversight) while SMC/Ang retains operational control. For PCOR equity investors, the credit positive framing is reassuring but secondary: the real story remains Brent $115+ and 84% FY2025 earnings growth. The government stake scenario, if it materializes, adds a credit floor to the equity.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

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- **Stance:** ACCUMULATE PCOR. CreditSights "Outperform" on the perpetual bond + "modestly credit positive" on government stake = credit market validating the thesis. Equity case rests on sole domestic refiner at Brent $115+, not on the ownership structure.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

DD 9.13

- **DD / Hotel101 (DoubleDragon / Hotel101 Global) — Hotel101 Eyes $300M US Series A Preferred Share Offering; April 22 Extraordinary General Meeting Called**
- Hotel101 Global Holdings Corp. (Nasdaq: HBNB), the Nasdaq-listed subsidiary of DoubleDragon Corp., called an extraordinary general meeting on or about April 22, 2026 to approve amendments enabling a $300 million (≈₱18.2 billion) Series A perpetual preferred share offering in the US. Proceeds will fund global Hotel101 expansion via joint ventures and licensing agreements. The company opened Hotel101-Madrid (680 rooms) on March 10 — its first international property — designated as an official hotel partner for the Formula 1 Madrid Grand Prix in September 2026 under a 10-year MATCH Hospitality agreement. 2026 target: 2,229 new rooms across Madrid, Davao, Cebu, and Niseko (Japan). DoubleDragon shares rose 0.11% to ₱9.13.
- **Analysis:** The $300 million raise is the fuel for Hotel101's expansion from a Philippine-centric developer to a genuine 100-country asset-light hospitality platform. Madrid is the proof of concept — if F1 grand prix occupancy meets "above-industry levels," the licensing and JV model gets validated at the highest possible visibility moment. For DoubleDragon (PSE-listed parent), the key question is the residual equity value accruing to DD as Hotel101 dilutes through the preferred share offering. DD investors hold an indirect interest in a Nasdaq-listed vehicle growing its international room count from essentially zero to 2,229 in a single year.
- **Stance:** MONITOR DoubleDragon (DD). Hotel101's international rollout is an exciting optionality story but the preferred share offering is dilutive, and F1 Madrid execution risk is real. Accumulate DD on confirmed Hotel101 commercial traction in Madrid post-F1 Grand Prix (September 2026).

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

ALI 16.14

- **ALI (Ayala Land Inc.) — Launches ₱10B Share Buyback; Stock Hit 14-Year Low of ₱16.26 on Monday**
- Ayala Land's executive committee approved a ₱10 billion share buyback program effective April 1, following a 7.3% single-session collapse on Monday to ₱16.26 — its lowest close since 2012. Buyback will be conducted through open-market PSE purchases. ALI has fallen 27.57% year-to-date, sharply underperforming the PSEi's 3.25% decline. FY2025 net income rose 39% to ₱39.1 billion. The company previously returned ₱18.5 billion to investors via dividends and buybacks equivalent to ~65% of 2024 net income. ALI plans ₱40 billion in bond issuance in 2026 to fund a ₱90 billion+ capex program.
- **Analysis:** The ₱10 billion buyback at ₱16.26 is management putting money where its mouth is on valuation — at current prices, ALI trades at roughly P/E 4-5x FY2025 earnings of ₱39.1 billion, which is historically extreme undervaluation for the Philippines' largest property developer. The market is pricing in: rate hike risk (BSP April 23 meeting), construction cost inflation (cement +15-20%), and broader macro risk-off. All three are real headwinds. But the analyst consensus 12-month target of ₱32-33 implies 97%+ upside from current levels, and the FY2025 39% earnings growth proves the business is fundamentally intact.
- **Stance:** BUY ON WEAKNESS — ALI. At ₱16.14 (March 31 close), ALI trades at a 14-year low vs. 39% FY2025 earnings growth — a historically extreme dislocation. The ₱10 billion buyback provides price support on the PSE. 12-month consensus target ₱32.05 implies near-doubling. Accumulate in tranches at ₱15-17; target ₱32 over 12 months.

DMW 4.95

- **DMW (D.M. Wenceslao & Associates) — Included in ATRAM SDG Fund for Fourth Consecutive Year**
- D.M. Wenceslao & Associates (DMW) was included in the ATRAM Philippine Sustainable Development and Growth Fund for the fourth consecutive year, reflecting the company's integration of UN Sustainable Development Goals across its Aseana City development in Pasay. CEO Delfin Angelo Wenceslao: "Inclusion in the Atram SDG Fund for the fourth consecutive year affirms that sustainability is not peripheral to DMW's strategy; it is integral to how we create value." The ATRAM SDG Fund selects the top 20 PSE-listed companies based on SDG integration and has historically outperformed the PSEi.
- Analysis: Four consecutive years of inclusion in the ATRAM SDG Fund is a signal of consistent ESG governance, not a one-off. The fund's top-20 selection criteria provide institutional validation that DMW's Aseana City master-plan — with its commercial, residential, and logistics components in Pasay's bay reclamation area — meets sustainability standards that are increasingly screened by foreign institutional investors. For a mid-cap developer that competes for foreign fund flows, sustained ESG credential is a meaningful differentiator in a PSE market where foreign selling has been persistent.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

LPZ 3.64

- **Lopez Inc. / FGEN — 71% Lopez Majority Votes to Remove CEO Piki Lopez; Court Order Blocks Move; ₱125B First Gen Deals Cited**
- A 71% majority of Lopez Inc. — three family factions led by Eugenio "Gabby" Lopez III — confirmed the board voted 5-2 on February 27 to remove Federico "Piki" Lopez as president and CEO "for cause and loss of trust." Piki and his brother Benjamin dissented. A Mandaluyong RTC court granted Piki a writ of preliminary injunction on March 16, temporarily blocking the ouster; the majority has filed a motion to dissolve it. The dispute traces to Piki's refusal to inject ₱2 billion from Lopez Inc. reserves into debt-strapped ABS-CBN, and allegations by the majority of "questionable transactions" involving billions of pesos in First Gen Corp., the group's publicly listed power arm.
- **Analysis:** The Lopez family dispute is now a live governance crisis for First Gen (FGEN), the listed subsidiary at the center of the alleged ₱125 billion transaction concerns. FGEN investors face a holding company paralysis risk: if Lopez Inc. leadership remains contested in court, strategic decision-making at the board level of FGEN — which operates some of the Philippines' most critical natural gas and renewable power assets — could be slowed or contested. The Gabby-led majority's allegations of undisclosed large-scale transactions at FGEN are the most material risk, as they could trigger SEC/PSE inquiries and depress the stock.
- **Stance:** MONITOR FGEN — Governance Risk Elevated. The Lopez family court battle is now material to FGEN's corporate governance profile. Await resolution of the injunction (April 16 hearing) before accumulating. Existing holders: hold with watchful monitoring of FGEN disclosures for any related-party transaction announcements.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

GMA7 5.73, GMAP 5.65

- **GMA / All PSEi — Makati RTC Denies GMA's TRO vs. SEC Independent Director Term Limit Rule; Court Exposes Network's Concealed ASM Rescheduling**
- The Makati RTC Branch 38 denied GMA Network's application for a temporary restraining order against SEC MC7 Series 2026 — the 9-year cumulative independent director term limit. The court found no "extreme urgency" after the SEC revealed that GMA had already rescheduled its annual stockholders' meeting from May to December 2026, undercutting the network's claimed urgency. SEC Chairman Francis Lim: "Our people clamor against political dynasties — so our public companies must reject boardroom entrenchment. No double standards." A hearing on GMA's writ of preliminary injunction is set for April 16. The rule affects two GMA independent directors: former Chief Justice Artemio Panganiban and former BSP Governor Jaime Laya.
- **Analysis:** The TRO denial is a decisive win for the SEC — and the court's finding that GMA concealed the ASM rescheduling while claiming urgency damages the network's credibility in the litigation. GMA now has until December to find replacement independent directors, making the "extreme urgency" argument moot. The April 16 injunction hearing is the next milestone, but with urgency disposed of, the injunction petition is weakened. For all PSEi companies: MC7 enforcement is now court-validated at the first judicial test. Proactive ID rotation is the prudent corporate response.
- **Stance:** GOVERNANCE WATCH — All PSEi Companies. MC7 enforcement is judicially confirmed at the first test. GMA's concealment of ASM rescheduling backfired in court. For GMA specifically: NEUTRAL — governance friction + no franchise.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

PAL 3.55

- **PAL (Philippine Airlines Holdings) — FY2025 Net Income +6.1% to $160.4M; Revenue +3% to $3.22B; But 2026 Already Heavily Disrupted**
- Philippine Airlines reported FY2025 net income of $160.4 million, up 6.1%, on total revenues of $3.22 billion (+3%). Passenger revenues reached $2.73 billion as PAL carried 16.3 million travelers (+4.3%). Ancillary revenues surged 24.9% to $301.2 million; cargo revenues rose 3.7% to $165 million. Operating expenses climbed 6.3% to nearly $3 billion. The airline received its first Airbus A350-1000 in December 2025 — the first in Southeast Asia to operate the type.
- Against these strong 2025 fundamentals, PAL has already suspended Manila-Riyadh flights through April 8, cut Dubai routes through April 20, and reduced frequencies on Southeast Asian and Australian routes through October 2026, as jet fuel costs have "more than doubled" compared to 2025 averages.
- Analysis: The FY2025 report is a look in the rearview mirror — solid earnings growth, A350 fleet renewal, record ancillary revenues. The challenge is 2026: with jet fuel at $195/barrel (+116.8% YoY per IATA data) and Gulf route suspensions already underway, the cost and revenue headwinds are severe. The A350-1000 product upgrade is critical for long-haul yield recovery, but cannot compensate for lost Gulf corridor volumes in the near term. PAL's stronger international exposure (vs. CEB's 73% domestic) makes it more vulnerable to the current crisis.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

PGOLD 41.00

- **PGOLD (Puregold Price Club) — FY2025 Net Income +8.8% to ₱11.3B; Revenue +10% to ₱242.45B; SSSG Positive at Both Formats**
- Puregold Price Club reported FY2025 net income of ₱11.3 billion, up approximately 8.8% from ₱10.4 billion in 2024. Total revenues rose 10% to ₱242.45 billion. Same-store sales growth was positive across both formats: Puregold stores +4.1% driven by higher basket size; S&R Warehouse clubs +6.1% driven by more shoppers. The results reflect sustained demand in the mass-market grocery and warehouse club segments despite a challenging consumer environment.
- Analysis: Puregold's FY2025 result is exactly what the market needed to see: positive SSSG at both Puregold (+4.1%) and S&R (+6.1%), double-digit revenue growth, and mid-single-digit earnings expansion. For 2026, the energy emergency creates a two-way dynamic — higher transportation and logistics costs pressure gross margins, but staple grocery demand (particularly at mass-market price points) is structurally inelastic. Puregold and S&R serve different customer segments but both benefit from the flight to value that accompanies fuel price shocks: consumers cut discretionary spending and eat at home more, driving grocery traffic. PGOLD is a defensive consumer staples play in the current crisis environment.
- Stance: ACCUMULATE PGOLD. FY2025 earnings growth +8.8% with positive SSSG across both formats. Energy emergency is a net positive for mass-market grocery (trade-down from foodservice + higher home consumption). PGOLD at ₱39.70 is defensive value in a volatile market.

NEWS, ANALYSIS , INVESTING INSIGHT

TEL 1,295.00

- **TEL / GLO (PLDT-Smart / Globe) — Ready to Block Roblox if NTC Orders; Child Safety Platform Already Blocking 176,000+ Incidents Monthly**
- PLDT and Smart Communications confirmed readiness to immediately comply if the NTC issues a formal directive to block access to Roblox, the popular online gaming platform. The government placed Roblox under strict monitoring following complaints over alleged exposure of minors to harmful content, violent extremism, and predatory behavior, including a March incident where seven teenagers aged 15 in Laguna were found planning a mass shooting linked to Roblox contacts. The CICC gave Roblox until April 10 to respond; Globe Telecom also confirmed readiness to comply. In the first two months of 2026 alone, PLDT-Smart blocked 176,000 attempts to access child abuse-linked content.
- **Analysis:** The Roblox story is a regulatory compliance event for PLDT and Globe, not a business model shift. Both telcos have existing child protection platforms and blocking infrastructure — compliance with an NTC directive is operationally straightforward. There is no material revenue impact: Roblox traffic does not generate direct revenue for telcos. The more significant angle is reputational: PLDT and Globe proactively aligning with the government on child safety regulation signals responsible corporate citizenship and reduces regulatory risk in their license renewal contexts. For Roblox Corporation (not PSE-listed), a Philippine block would be commercially immaterial given approximately 5.1 million Philippine DAUs out of 88+ million globally.
- **Stance:** NEUTRAL on TEL and GLO re: Roblox. Compliance is regulatory housekeeping — no earnings impact either way. The child protection platform narrative is a modest positive for regulatory goodwill. Maintain existing stances: ACCUMULATE TEL (telco infrastructure + Smart 5G); MONITOR GLO (capex cycle completion watch).

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	3/31/2026	4/1/2026	%Chg
AC	500	503.5	0.70%
ACEN	2.84	2.95	3.87%
AEV	29.5	29.8	1.02%
ALI	16.26	16.14	-0.74%
AREIT	38.35	39.5	3.00%
BDO	113.4	112.8	-0.53%
BPI	96	99.9	4.06%
CBC	64.8	64	-1.23%
CNPF	33.2	35	5.42%
CNVRG	12.3	12.2	-0.81%
DMC	9.99	9.98	-0.10%
EMI	15.28	16	4.71%
GLO	1,638.00	1,625.00	-0.79%
GTCAP	506	520	2.77%
ICT	693	688	-0.72%
JFC	177	177.7	0.40%
JGS	27.5	27.6	

PSE-INDEX STOCKS

PSEi

	3/31/2026	4/1/2026	%Chg
LTG	14.42	14.66	1.66%
MBT	63.3	63.5	0.32%
MER	604	617.5	2.24%
MONDE	6.44	6.67	3.57%
PGOLD	40	41	2.50%
PLUS	16.04	15.98	-0.37%
RCR	6.57	6.63	0.91%
SCC	28.55	28.65	0.35%
SM	590	620	5.08%
SMC	72	71.8	-0.28%
SMPH	19.54	20.45	4.66%
TEL	1,295.00	1,295.00	0.00%
URC	65	65.3	0.46%

TRENDING STOCKS

DIVIDEND YIELD INDEX (PSE DivY)

	3/31/2026	4/1/2026	%Chg
AREIT	38.35	39.5	3.00%
CBC	64.8	64	-1.23%
CREIT	3.38	3.4	0.59%
DMC	9.99	9.98	-0.10%
DNL	3.55	3.6	1.41%
GLO	1,638.00	1,625.00	-0.79%
LTG	14.42	14.66	1.66%
MBT	63.3	63.5	0.32%
MER	604	617.5	2.24%
MREIT	13.6	13.52	-0.59%
NIKL	4.13	4.2	1.69%
OGP	31	31.8	2.58%
PGOLD	40	41	2.50%
RCR	6.57	6.63	0.91%
RLC	16.98	17.4	2.47%
RRHI	46.55	46.2	-0.75%
SCC	28.55	28.65	0.35%
SGP	22.05	22.1	0.23%
TEL	1,295.00	1,295.00	0.00%
URC	65	65.3	0.46%

TRENDING STOCKS

PSE MidCap

	3/31/2026	4/1/2026	%Chg
AGI	9	8.98	-0.22%
APX	14.36	14.88	3.62%
AUB	41.1	42	2.19%
BLOOM	1.99	2.03	2.01%
COSCO	6.92	6.9	-0.29%
DNL	3.55	3.6	1.41%
GSMI	273.8	275.6	0.66%
KEEPR	2.12	2.16	1.89%
MEG	2.06	2.1	1.94%
MREIT	13.6	13.52	-0.59%
MWC	41.7	42.35	1.56%
NIKL	4.13	4.2	1.69%
OGP	31	31.8	2.58%
PNB	55.65	56.25	1.08%
RLC	16.98	17.4	2.47%
RRHI	46.55	46.2	-0.75%
SECB	65.45	65.2	-0.38%
SEVN	33.7	34.15	1.34%
SGP	22.05	22.1	0.23%
WLCON	6	6.02	0.33%